

12. Old Black Joe

Stephen C. Foster

This is another of the songs by Stephen C. Foster and is similar to the others. It has always been a peculiar favorite with men and boys. Considerable free

1. Gone are the days when my heart was young and
2. Why do I weep when my heart should feel no
3. Where are the hearts once so hap - py and so

Gone are my friends from the
Why do I sigh that my
chil - dren so dear that I

cot - ton-fields a-way; Gone from the earth to a bet-ter land I know, I
friends come not a-gain? Grie-ving for forms now de-part-ed long a-go, I
held up - on my knee? Gone to the shore where my soul has longed to go, I

CHORUS

hear their gen-tle voi-ces call-ing, "Old Black Joe!" I'm com-ing, I'm com-ing, For my
hear their gen-tle voi-ces call-ing, "Old Black Joe!"
hear their gen-tle voi-ces call-ing, "Old Black Joe!"

10

head is bend-ing low; I hear those gen - tle voi - ces call - ing, "Old Black Joe!"

The musical score consists of two staves, treble and bass, with a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#). The melody is written in the treble clef, and the accompaniment is in the bass clef. The lyrics are written below the treble staff. The score is divided into three measures. The first measure contains the lyrics 'head is bend-ing low;'. The second measure contains 'I hear those gen - tle voi - ces call - ing,'. The third measure contains '"Old Black Joe!'"'. The melody in the treble staff features a series of eighth notes in the first measure, a half note in the second, and a half note with a fermata in the third. The bass staff provides a steady accompaniment with eighth notes in the first measure, a half note in the second, and a half note with a fermata in the third.